

TEACHER KEY · NOT FOR STUDENTS

Growth & Development

Sample answers · Weeks 25–30

Mr. Fung · EIPS · 2026–2027

1. Week 25 — Changes during adolescence
2. Week 26 — Puberty facts
3. Week 27 — Organs and jobs
4. Week 28 — Two signs of capacity
5. Week 29 — Practices that support a maturing body
6. Week 30 — Growth wrap

Week 25: Maturation and Changes in Adolescence

Changes during adolescence

Change / Physical, thinking, or behaviour? / A supportive response

Needing more sleep: Sleep — physical — do not tease; growing bodies need rest.

Caring more what friends think: Friends — thinking/behaviour — normal; still use your values.

Growth spurt / clothes don't fit: Clothes — physical — different timelines, no ranking.

Wanting a closed bedroom door more often: Door — behaviour — privacy can be independence; families can still check in.

Why is it unkind to rank who “hit puberty” first?

Bodies are not a race. Ranking makes people feel watched. Timing varies. Comparing bodies in class is not allowed.

Exit ticket — Name one physical, one thinking, and one behaviour change that can happen in adolescence.

Physical: needing more sleep. Thinking: caring more about a group project. Behaviour: wanting a closed door for homework.

Look-fors

- Can they use the three categories?
- No pointing at classmates?

Tip. Giggles are normal. Reset once (“we use calm science voices”) and continue. Do not shame.

Week 26: Physical Changes During Puberty

Puberty facts

Statement / Fact or myth? / Why

Everyone starts puberty at the same age.: Myth — timing varies.

Hormones are chemical messengers.: Fact — they tell the body to change or do a job.

Sweat and skin oil often increase.: Fact — secondary characteristics can include more oil and sweat.

You can tell everything about a person from how fast they grow.: Myth — growth speed is not character, smarts, or worth.

Two physical changes I might notice or that a friend might notice (general, not naming a classmate)

A growth spurt that makes clothes short, and needing deodorant because sweat increases.
General facts, not a person in this room.

Exit ticket — Who is a trusted adult I could ask a puberty question?

A parent or guardian, or my teacher. Questions can also go in the class question box.

Look-fors

- Hormones defined simply?
- Myths about same-age start and judging bodies busted?

Tip. If a student is visibly anxious, offer to complete the sheet in a quieter space. Same content.

Week 27: Puberty and Reproductive Capacity

Organs and jobs

Part / Job in your own words

Ovaries: Ovaries: store egg cells. **Uterus:** muscular organ with a lining. **Vagina:** canal; **vulva:** outside parts. **Testicles:** sperm and testosterone. **Penis:** urine and, later, semen. **Scrotum:** holds the testicles.

What does “capacity for human reproduction” mean in Grade 5 language?

The body is becoming able, in the future, to produce egg or sperm cells. That is not the same as being ready to parent, and we are not studying sexual activity.

What are we not learning this year (Grade 6 content)?

The fertilization-through-pregnancy-and-birth sequence, contraception, and dating advice. That is Grade 6 and later.

Exit ticket — Why do we use correct anatomical words instead of slang?

Slang turns the lesson into a joke contest and can humiliate people. Correct words keep it science.

Look-fors

- Organs matched to jobs with correct words?
- Capacity distinguished from “ready to parent”?
- No Grade 6 pregnancy/birth sequence?

Tip. If your school provides diagrams, keep them scientific and unlabeled until students fill jobs. No phones. Pass is allowed.

Week 28: Menstruation and Sperm Production

Two signs of capacity

Process / What happens, in Grade 5 language

Menstruation / a period: Period: uterus lining leaves the body through the vagina for a few days; first ones can be irregular.

Ovulation (one line): Ovulation: an ovary releases an egg.

Sperm production / semen: Testicles make sperm; sperm plus fluid is semen.

One hygiene or help step (pad, wash, trusted adult, extra clothes) a person might need

A pad in underwear, wash hands, extra clothes in a bag, tell a trusted adult or the office if I am unprepared or in a lot of pain.

Why does everyone in Grade 5 learn both systems?

These are human body systems. Classmates deserve dignity. You may need to be a respectful friend.

Exit ticket — What does “sign of reproductive capacity” mean — and what does it not mean?

It means the system is maturing so pregnancy could become possible later. It does not mean someone is ready to parent, and it is not a lesson on sexual activity.

Look-fors

- Both processes stated without slang?
- Hygiene named without embarrassment theatre?
- Grade 6 sequence left in Grade 6?

Tip. Know where pads are in your building before this lesson. Answer question-box items factually next class. Skip anything that is not Grade 5 PEW.

Week 29: Positive Health Practices During Puberty

Practices that support a maturing body

Practice / What this could look like for me this month

Sleep: Sleep: phone out of bed when I can. Food: water + a protein-and-fruit snack after gym. Activity: intramurals twice a week. Hygiene: deodorant in the backpack. Stress: a walk after a loud day. Adult: parent and my teacher.

Exit ticket — How do positive health practices support a healthy reproductive system — in one kid sentence?

Sleep, food, movement, hygiene, and less stress help the whole body, including the systems that are maturing, work the way they are supposed to.

Look-fors

- Six practices attempted?
- No body-ranking language?

Tip. Some students cannot control bedtime or food at home. Keep items in the student's circle of control. School water and school movement count.

Week 30: Connecting Puberty to Well-Being

Growth wrap

Puberty is... (one accurate sentence)

Puberty is the set of physical changes, driven by hormones, that lead toward adult reproductive capacity. Timing varies.

Capacity for human reproduction means... (and does not mean...)

It means the body is becoming able to produce egg or sperm cells. It does not mean someone is ready to parent, and it is not a lesson on sexual activity or birth.

One physical, one thinking, and one behaviour change

Physical: growth spurt. Thinking: caring more about a group project. Behaviour: wanting more privacy.

Two positive health practices I can keep

Water bottle and deodorant in the bag; talk to a trusted adult instead of a comment section.

Exit ticket — How does accurate, respectful knowledge about puberty support well-being?

Facts replace rumours. Respect replaces ranking. People can ask for help. That supports well-being during a stage that already feels loud.

Look-fors

- Accurate language?
- Capacity vs ready?
- No Grade 6 content sneaking in?

Tip. Score the growth rubric once. Keep returned family-letter slips in a folder. Students who opted out should already have been on the alternate task — never a public list.